
OXFORD AQA INTERNATIONAL A-LEVEL ENGLISH LITERATURE

UNIT 3: ELEMENTS OF CRIME AND MYSTERY

Specimen

Morning

Time allowed: 2 hours

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- a 12-page answer booklet.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book. The **Examining Body** for this paper is Oxford International AQA Exams.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work that you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **two** questions.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- You will be marked on your ability to:
 - use good English
 - organise information clearly
 - analyse carefully the writers' methods
 - use specialist vocabulary where appropriate.

Answer **two** questions.

Either

0	1
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William Shakespeare: *Macbeth*

‘Macbeth is a natural-born killer.’

Discuss Shakespeare’s presentation of Macbeth in the light of this statement.

[25 marks]

or

0	2
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Samuel Taylor Coleridge: *The Rime of the Ancient Mariner*

‘*The Rime of the Ancient Mariner* is essentially a moral tale.’

How far do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

or

0	3
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Robert Browning: *Selected Poems*

‘The resolutions of Robert Browning’s poetry tell us that crime does pay.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

In your answer you should make reference to ‘The Laboratory’ and **at least one other poem**.

[25 marks]

or

0	4
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Charles Dickens: *Oliver Twist*

In *Oliver Twist* Dickens presents violence against others as the most unforgivable of crimes.

To what extent do you agree with this view of the novel?

[25 marks]

or

0	5
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Edgar Allen Poe: *Collected Stories*

To what extent do you agree that the crimes in Poe’s short stories are acts of inexplicable violence?

In your answer you should make reference to ‘The Black Cat’ and **at least one other story**.

[25 marks]

or

0	6
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Robert Louis Stevenson: *Collected Stories*

‘Stevenson’s crime writing explores the idea that criminal savagery is ever present within polite society.’

Discuss this view of Stevenson’s stories with reference to ‘Jekyll and Hyde’ and **at least one other story**.

[25 marks]

or

0	7
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Agatha Christie: *The Murder of Roger Ackroyd*

‘Hercule Poirot is indeed the ‘super-detective’ that Dr Sheppard describes him as.’

How far do you agree with the view that Christie presents Poirot as having an almost supernatural investigative ability?

[25 marks]

or

0	8
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Qiu Xialong: *Death of a Red Heroine*

‘The opening murder in *Death of a Red Heroine* sets the tone for a novel in which every character is corrupt.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

or

0	9
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Kate Atkinson: *When Will There Be Good News?*

‘Jackson had never been one to say no, either to goddesses or to requests for help.’

How far do you agree that Jackson Brodie is presented as a force for justice in *When Will There Be Good News?*

[25 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

There are no questions printed on this page